Hai Hong Ph.D. Candidate

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Education

School of Public Affairs, Zhejiang University — Zhejiang, China
Ph.D. in Agricultural Economics — 2023 - 2028 *(expected)*
- Advisor: Prof. Kevin Chen
- Research Interests: Environmental Economics, Development Economics, Chinese Economy

Department of Economics, University of Toronto — Ontario, Canada
International Visiting Graduate Student — 2026-2027
- Advisor: Prof. Eduardo Souza-Rodrigues

School of Economics, Anhui University — Anhui, China
B.E. in Economics — 2019 - 2023

Publications

1. **Hai Hong**, Kevin Chen. "When the Fire Ends: Straw Burning, Regulation, and Pollution Substitution." ***Journal of Development Economics***, 2026.
CAER-IFPRI Best Paper Award.
2. **Hai Hong**, Yunfei Zhang, Kevin Chen. "In the Name of Love: Policy Imitation, Political Incentives, and Local Economic Growth." ***Economic Development and Cultural Change***, Accepted.
3. **Hai Hong**, Kevin Chen. "When the Wind Blows: Agricultural Fire Exposure, Parental Investment, and Long-term Outcomes." ***Journal of Population Economics***, 2026.
4. **Hai Hong**, Yongbin Huang. "Order! The Border: Multitasking, Air Pollution Regulation, and Local Government Responses." ***Journal of Environmental Economics and Management***, 2025.

Working Papers

1. **Hai Hong**, Yi Shi, Zenghui Li, Kevin Chen. "Harvesting the Concrete: Urban Expansion and Agricultural Land Productivity." ***Revise & Resubmit*** at ***Regional Science and Urban Economics***
2. Yuchen Guo, **Hai Hong**, Wentong Sun. "Departure from the Dust: Dust Storms, Migration, and Economic Outcomes" ***Submitted***
3. Kevin Chen, Jiajun Min, **Hai Hong**. "Biofuel Policy, Trade Reallocation, and Deforestation." ***Submitted***
4. Yongbin Huang, Chuanyang Shi, **Hai Hong**. "Toxic Manipulation: Contaminated Sites, Redevelopment, and Urban Land Misallocation." ***Submitted***

Selected Work in Progress

1. **Hai Hong**, Peng Zhang, Eric Zou, Kevin Chen. "Unmonitored Fires."
2. **Hai Hong**, Kevin Chen. "The Design and Implementation of Optimal Straw Utilization Policy in China: A Quantitative Analysis."
3. **Hai Hong**, Kevin Chen. "Purge and Parity: Anti-Corruption, Female Leader, and Political Outcomes."
4. **Hai Hong**, Kevin Chen. "So Let the River Run: Social Ties and Inter-jurisdictional Water Pollution."
5. Zichuan Guo, **Hai Hong**, Zi Li. "Dark Side of Light: The Sacrifice and Achievement of Non-Pilot Area."

Research Projects

- Pathways and Strategies for Transforming China's Food System in the New Era. **Ministry of Education**, *2023-2026*. Participate
- CGIAR Climate Action Science Program (AOW5 on Policy and Financing), *2025-2026*. Participate
- CGIAR Low Carbon Food System Research Initiative (Mitigate +), *2022-2024*. Participate

Pre-doctoral Works

1. Yongbin Huang, **Hai Hong**. "The Premium of the Old Neighborhood Upgrading Projects in China: Evidence from Hefei." ***Journal of Housing and Building Environment***, 2024.
2. Yongbin Huang, **Hai Hong**. "The Heterogeneous Impact of House Purchase Limits Policy on Housing Prices: Comparison between Elite and Non-elite School District Houses." ***Real Estate Economics***, 2023. (**REE Top Cited Paper**)
3. Yongbin Huang, **Hai Hong**. "Expressways and the Economic Growth of Border Areas."

Seminar & Conference

2026 **Climate Change Economic Forum (Online)**

2025 **SHINE-YES-with-NO (SJTU), China Health Economics Forum (XMU), RUSE International Workshop (WHU), CES Annual Conference (SYSU), READ Seminars (SJTU-ZJU; PKU-ZJU).**

2024 **CCER-NCER China Economic Symposium (PKU), CAER-IFPRI Annual Conference (HNU), CES Annual Conference (ZJU).**

Skills

Languages: Mandarin Chinese (Native), English (Fluent) .

Programming: `Stata`, `R`, `Matlab`, `ArcGIS`, `Python`, LaTeX

Referee Services

American Journal of Agricultural Economics, Economics and Human Biology, Environmental and Resource Economics, Food Policy, Humanities and Social Science Communications, Journal of Development Economics, Journal of Environmental Economics and Management (×2)